- Men appear to reap the most physical health benefits from marriage and suffer the greatest health consequences if they divorce.
- Married mothers have lower rates of depression than single or cohabiting mothers, probably because they are more likely to receive practical and emotional support from their husband and his family.

Marriage and Wealth

- Married couples build more wealth on average than singles or cohabiting couples.
- Married men earn more money than do single men with similar education and job histories.
- Married women are economically better off than divorced, cohabiting or never-married women.

Marriage and Children

- Less likely to be poor or to experience persistent economic insecurity.
- More likely to stay in school, have fewer behavioural and attendance problems, and earn four-year college degrees.
- Less vulnerable to serious emotional illness, depression and suicide attempts.
- More likely to have positive attitudes towards marriage and greater success in forming lasting marriages.

Marriage and Crime/Domestic Violence

- Married women are at lower risk for domestic violence than women in cohabiting or dating relationships.
- Boys raised in single-parent homes are more likely to engage in criminal and delinquent behaviours than those raised by two married biological parents.
- Married women are significantly less likely to be the victims of violent crime than single or divorced women. Married men are less likely to perpetrate violent crimes than unmarried men.

Marriage and Society

- The institution of marriage reliably creates the social, economic and affective conditions for effective parenting.
- Being married changes people's lifestyles and habits in ways that are personally and socially beneficial. Marriage is a "seedbed" of pro-social behaviour.
- Marriage generates social capital. The social bonds created through marriage yield benefits, not only for the family, but for others as well, including the larger society.

4.8 Application of Sociology in Nursing

- Sociology is a recent addition to the syllabus of medical education.
- Sociology is needed in general to all the medical professions and especially nursing because social conditions are sometimes responsible for health problems.
- Sociology helps to understand the relationship between disease and social condition.

Importance of social environment

- A patient with physical handicap should be understood in the context of his social milieu.
- Psychological, social and vocational handicaps of the disabled person and patients are often related with false attitute of the people.
- The nurse should understand the social environment for develop the patients health conditions.

SUMMARY

Sociology is just as valuable and important to nursing as is psychology. Sociology explores the issues of genders, social classes, stratification, families and economic policies which have impacts on health care and nursing.

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